

Elkdonis Arts Collective - Project Brainstorm

😊Earth, Art, and Anarchy: Between Worlds with the Elkdonis Collective😊

Actively record your contributions please. I'm going to trust @all to be responsible for what they want included because this document is how I will refine and build content.

TOUCHSTONES:

- [ROLES OF MEMBERS / DELEGATION OF TASKS](#)
- [INTENTION & 2026 WISHLIST](#)
- [Most Urgent Tasks !](#)

- [ARTIST / MISSION STATEMENT / PITCH](#)
- [\(Simplified Pitch\)](#)
- [\(Sufism\)](#)

- [WEBSITE](#)
- [To Edit the Current Website](#)

- [WORKSHOPS](#)
- [BUSINESS Strategy](#)
- [MARKETING Progress](#)

- [Documentary Proposal](#)
- [Outreach and Marketing Plan — Documentary Idea](#)
- [Current Grant Application Due March 2](#) (Done, you can see the responses here:
<https://cryptpad.fr/form/#/2/form/view/qANtKJom-y-HIMIMQx-to2O2tSKsstB11lCQ0VNB9Ls/>)

- [BOOK PUBLISHING WORLD LEARNING](#) (via course Dana is taking)

(Will Move to NextCloud Soon)... Nextcloud Advice:

1. Label your files with logical and descriptive names so we can find them when you upload something .
2. Pay attention to the existing folders and place new items in the nextcloud accordingly . This is just

good housekeeping.

General Advice:

1. If you start a new thing, please communicate actively what you're doing and track it / record your progress
2. it's important that all the multidimensionality stays pivoted around the central intention/ mission of Elkdonis Arts.
3. Actively update the group and check in about how whatever you do helps the original aims
4. Be responsible for contingency, in every way, every step of the way, (while still being clever about passive / active profit) **THIS MEANS: STAY AVAILABLE once you have an obligation to something requiring your hard consistent work to be profitable.** —--- Especially if you create a role only you can really do properly to prevent loss or error. —----- Or, you have to have an accomplice for whatever you create and clearly communicate if you have to leave and transfer the responsibility , or hire someone.

MODERATIONS

1. digression = distraction. There's a time and place for everything. It's very important we finish the key tasks we identify from start to finish. This can be done a number of ways, for example with 1-2 people making a commitment to follow through.
2. No follow through is a weakness for many people here ---- it's completely normal and it's how the creative universe works. To finish octaves we need someone creating this friction - basically I'm only reminding you to stay focused.

CONCLUSION: Do what thou wilt , but consider follow thru and see it through to the end --- actively communicate challenges, opportunities, touchstones or major accomplishments.

CONCLUSION 1.2: It's about Coherence --- this requires some simplicity, some limits, containment.

Our 2026 Intention: To create meaningful, high paying and even REMOTE employment opportunities for all of us

2026 Wishlist — - it's nice to have a wishlist (See 5 Ws and How)

1. **Bookstore / Store Front** (maybe it's a pilot project or a nomadic event first....)

Jason might be able to do a small scale pilot project - it would double as an antiques shop and gallery /event space – concept of “bookstore” is generous

1.2. Event Space physical auditorium / stage for theater and large scale seminars/classes/workshops

2: Online events where we somehow build a following and everything that comes with that / an active website / app....

2.1 See [WORKSHOPS](#)

2.2 Better [WEBSITE](#)

3. Monetized value in some form --- making sure this is profitable and worthwhile every step of the way. It could happen through many channels , such as publishing writing , events, workshops...

3.1: See [BUSINESS Strategy](#)

3.2: See [MARKETING Progress](#)

3.3: [See Grant Application](#)

4: Publishing & Writing Content : writing about the occult +

Could Elkdoris Arts produce a similar magazine, but fourth way focused. , I wonder? (example:

<https://www.instagram.com/p/DS5qxWcExgx/?igsh=aGloenByCHB2NHA4>)

4.1: Better [ARTIST / MISSION STATEMENT / PITCH](#)

4.2: SUBSTACK as a real place to start.

4.3 [A DOCUMENTARY????](#)

Roles of Members / Task Delegation in 2026:

PAPERWORK - Ario & @Stephan: not for profit paperwork & behind the scenes legal foundation, Co-op Organization (?)

IT - Stephan: Next cloud set up

MARKETING - Main: Sarah & Ario (& Dana, Justin - only for design) : marketing strategies, implementation of sales pitch

STORE FRONT PILOT - Jason Ford: some kind of small store front quest / pilot project ,tour of Canada

CONTENT WRITERS / EDITORS / SCRIBES - Dana & Jason : content writing

WEBSITE DESIGN - Justin (& Dana, design consultant only): code design of a unique website, app ?

ONLINE ACTIVITIES OFFERED:

DANA has a creative writing course already designed and ready as a product

JASON has performance labs ready as a product

ARIO can offer music education in two different course programs, as well as enneagram workshops.

1. A: drum circles and rhythm attunement. B: tuning the body and mind through interval training (sangrehouse.com)
2. workshops on the enneagram (hiddenenneagram.com)

ARIO has websites dedicated to both of those programs i listed that i linked for you

IN PERSON ACTIVITIES (FUTURE):

JASON can leverage rock balancing as a curator

JUSTIN may also be hosting an artist residency in the ashram

DANA may potentially do the creative writing and collage in person in London, Paris or other European city

STEPHAN suggested a “co-op” (*please explain*)

NETWORKING:

(DANA IN EUROPE): European outreach, Internal group activities organizer, (eventually) can offer a lot of facilitation and education services, I am researching all kinds of websites and cultural phenomenons and movements constantly also, including digital communities where Elkdons Arts can run a public seminar to thousands of people interested in arts education

(ARIO IN USA): i've been actively seeking funding and also exposure to create possibilities here

(JASON, JUSTIN IN CANADA): Ashram...? Rock Balancing and retreat center? Tour with rock balancing ?

(EVERYONE ELSE & ONLINE NETWORKS): Networking in your own area, side quests.... List them here.

MOST Needed: What exactly are the Next Best Steps?

1. **Website needs work****** = We have to decide on basic products that we are ready to offer for the website to have good content.

2. **Marketing Foundation = Business Strategy** = This is how we will bring in clients / customers for the products. Social media pages?

2.1. **Products / Events** = This is how we will actually start making money. (Or is it only one way?)

3. **Paperwork Foundation = Funding Foundation.**

1. New Website - Design Strategy

(for Grant application but also generally) (Dana)

Emphasize we are creating a web 3.0 infrastructure. We mean to support artists by employing it.

Dana — **So for now what exists is what we have to promote more or less**, I'm into the creative book  style website design. It's all good. But just a note, **we're still going to need something ASAP that's functional to start our projects even if we improve on the website gradually or launch it later.**

- Current Website: <http://elkdonis-arts.org/>

Additional look at future website template (for now) eac.elkdonis-arts.org

- Plans for Improved Website:

Justin: We might have something as. Big background image. Elkdonis Arts Collective (As join .)

Sign up page. Then Thank you we will get back to you--- But that way we have their contact info already. That's the main part of the site anyways.

[2026-02-20] Justin: More website thoughts:

Video player that runs our video roll. Constant stream of our selected content.... that is replaced by our video conference stream whenever a meeting is held.

I'm done keeping things private too... at this point we can host all publicly... like our discussion besides perhaps this whatsapp

TO EDIT THE LIVE CURRENT WEBSITE — The landing page as it is right now is on a WordPress so anyone can edit it. The login and password is :

Gurudharamsingh@gmail.com

Ea4thway!

[This is the link to get to the Wordpress site you need](#)

Dana: I propose at least 3 distinctive pages / tabs :

- A tab on the website called Manifesto (this is the artist statement) - This can be the landing page / home page.
- A tab on the website called current projects & workshops - Products and hosted meetings / events go here
- A tab on the website called About (members'..... founding story...)

WEBSITE: I have been working on great ideas for restructuring the website and some time this week

I will implement as much as I can (I might need help). MORE SPECIFIC BREAKDOWN AS FOLLOWS:

1. Manifesto / mission statement tab with all the basic premises

- **THIS SHOULD BE THE SAME AS THE HOME / LANDING PAGE**

2. Entrepreneurship / community activation tab ---

- **no idea what would go here but**
- **if we create micro grants for artists?**
- **Networking events?**
- **SUBscription / Membership Portal?**

3. Activities / Workshops tab --- will have subsections:

- **--- A: "Experiential (experimental?) Labs" (different from workshops in some way, no???)....**
- **--- B: General directory of online workshops (creative writing, spiritual healing, what else so far?----?)**
- **---C: Reading groups --- more online library / knowledge / books / literature oriented To get us started**

4. Fourth way specific content can live under it's own tab / section of the website (?)

- **should this be scattered throughout the website or concentrated?**
- **If it's concentrated it's going to be less noticable for a government granter who reviews the website which might be a temporary advantage .**
- **Should it be housed under activities?**

Once we are happy with the website and the legal status.... Then the next big group task is branding / marketing (and we might even invite another person to help, or use the skills we have* I address my own strengths / weakness with marketing in the fundraising tab)

2. Business Strategy:

(Dana) We should get more clear on the timeline of how this is going to work because imo the sooner we can profit from products and efforts the better.

End of May / June 2026 onwards it's possible for me to just work for Elkdonis full time , but it has to be ready for a launch by then for that to happen. First week of March I have time to gather a lot of content and write several pages for the website

Jason (02/26): *I will be proposing a way to get clarification on our personal and group mission statements and aims (JASON PLEASE ADD THIS HERE****)*

I have a process that we could complete to facilitate greater clarity.

I think that we can get an online used bookstore and media lending library going now . I want to call it fun center. I will also be presenting some information about starting our online used bookstore and media library. I think each of us should be doing a blog asap.

I will be introducing an interconnect flow structure diagram/chart that will be useful.

Justin (02/26): *I think end of May is very reasonable to have everything we need up and running to start really bringing people in to the container*

(JASON) [FREE LEGAL ADVICE WEBSITE FOR FORMS](#)

(STEPHAN: I've been looking it over and we don't need to talk to a lawyer until/if we apply for charitable status. Everything else can be done online.)

(Stephan) THINGS WE NEED TO CONSIDER ABOUT FOR PROFIT / NOT FOR PROFIT:

[2026-02-27] Stephan: Hey @Elkdonis Arts, Ario and I have almost completed the incorporation. We're still needing some full names and addresses for the board of directors. There's something else to consider though. In a Not-For-Profit Corporation only 1/3 of the Directors are allowed to be employed by the corporation. We have to have at least 3 people as Directors and 2 of them can not be employed. I'm happy to be one of them. So if we stick to the minimum board of 3 then we still need 1 other person as Director who won't be employed. So, if we want a larger Board of Directors with everyone on it, we need more people who won't be employed

(RESPONDING TO.... DANA...) (I assume that this is just paperwork and has noothing to do with who does or doesn't use or recieve money. Can everyone else please chime in? @Ario New Number are you one of the other "employed" people ? I have a question about how this will affect your American taxes / (same thing I'm thinking of for France). Do the "employed" directors have to be living in Canada or is this not important is my first question. Second Q, what are the advantages / disadvantages to claiming employment or not with a not for profit? Can you break it down logically @Stephan ? (Practically, why can this matter / not matter?). If I am applying for grants and will be the person recieving the money I might have to be one of the employed directors.)

A normal corporation is organized to create profit for its shareholders. A not-for-profit corporation has a mission and any extra funds at the end of the year go back into it and are not distributed. That being said you can, as a director, be employed by a not-for-profit. The reason for the limit to 1/3 as employees is to prevent conflicts of interest between the board of directors who are supposed to lead and govern the corporation and its employees.

What do you mean by receive money? The corporation would receive the money and then employees would do as the board of directors says to direct those funds to activities that the corporation wants.

Directors don't have to be residents and neither do employees. Generally (besides that US and Somalian citizens) you are taxed where you officially reside.

I'm not sure what you mean by claiming employment? You are either employed or not. You either receive a salary or you don't. There's no direct benefit for you personally to work for a not-for-profit. The benefits happen for the corporation because it doesn't get taxed the same way as a person.

Yes, I would say you'd have to be an employed director if you'll be working with the funds received by the corporation.

(RESPONDING TO... (JUSTIN)...)

[12:14 a.m., 2026-02-28] Justin Gillis?: Again.. highly advise you consider your selves self-employed.... establish your own business. Then elkdoris can grant you things to support. This makes everyone and elkdoris look stronger... but this may be beside who does what , we should do this either way.

[12:19 a.m., 2026-02-28] Justin: We all would love to be 'employed' to be otherwise is basically the short end of the stick... it could easily be steph and I are employed by you to work to make you money while we get ... clout? So what this really is is a thing structure of representation... I deeply encourage you all to consider getting a LinkedIn we all will have webpages. Create a name for your "business" then start saying whatever you do in this group is work history pro Bono or whatever... Elkdoris looks both like it is hiring and creating jobs. As well as supporting growing business/artists.

So consider your role in your community first.

[12:19 a.m., 2026-02-28] Justin Gillis?: It doesn't make sense for Jason or Sarah to not be 'employeeed' if they don't have to be. If one of them doesn't want then I'll step down

[10:48 a.m., 2026-02-28] Stephan: So. This is possible but there is a conflict of interest if the corporation is hiring a business of one of the directors so a few things need to be done for it to be legal. The director needs to submit a conflict of interest to the board and then not be present at the meeting when the board votes that it's in the best interest of the corporation (fair price and such) so while technically possible there are some hoops to jump through.

[10:56 a.m., 2026-02-28] Stephan: Ok. I believe a distinction needs to be made. Being a director (a board member) is a voluntary position. Being the officer of board (CEO, CFO, etc) is an office you can hold on the board but isn't necessarily paid. There can be what they call "reasonable remuneration" but it's not officially an "employed" position.

[10:59 a.m., 2026-02-28] Stephan: @Dana / Rosemarie I'm still not entirely sure about the question about advantages/disadvantages. I guess I'd have to know more about your situation. Visas can complicate things for sure. I'd be happy to try to help figure out what's best for your situation if you want to chat about it. With the caveat that I'm not a tax expert just someone who has had to deal with tax in multiple countries.

Proposal for business contracts under Elkdoris:

We can offer these services as b2b contractors of elkdoris for now. i.e. elkdoris hires me for X course under a specific contract ??? (Ario): I think this is most straightforward way for us to approach ALL of our "businesses" or activities that we contribute to elkdoris at least for starters:

- we each hire ourselves as contractees of elkdoris to provide X service.
- this way it gets logged as cash flow through elkdoris — which is the main thing needed anyway
- we discuss whatever terms for the contracts in a way that supports the group and the individual leading the activity
- these items can be “owned” or “offered” by existing separate businesses or individuals
- ***we just have to do research as to how to devise this legally and by the books****

ATTENTION: adding layers to the entity will make it more complicated. ! Solution: lateral moves such as direct contracts would make for an easier trail.

Proposal: we each devise specific packages or services that we offer as efforts to elkdoris as:

- ☐ -categorized (seminar, workshop, book reading, etc) and sub categorized further into topic (music , art, magick, history, etc)
- ☐ -priced
- ☐ -detailed with collaborator's individual or business name
- ☐ -articulated items (curricula, supporting material, scope of work, participant minimums and maximums, period of session)

Then each of these packages are written as collaboration:

- **Example: "elkdoris arts presents X in collaboration with dana mccoil"**

Then this item can be purchased by elkdoris, thus separating the non profit from the packages provided - allowing Elkdoris to act as the third force for the service.

package is active force — audience passive force — elkdoris third force

Dana (01/03/26): Look into PRS as role model - They are NFPO in USA. They have money and use it with an apparently similar model. *Advice to Ario: You could host a workshop with PRS yourself you know Then you would really gain direct insight*

Talking to people in an open , professional manner with full transparency about our sister project is another valid way to do "research". Depending on how it's done you can potentially ask PRS staff directly.

Stephan (01/03/26) : "I've been looking into it and this all seems like it can work. A nonprofit can either employ or contract the work that it needs. The main things that has to be done, if the person who is getting hired as an employee or a contractor is a director, are a declaration of conflict of interest, the person being hired can't be part of the hiring decision and they have to be paid a "fair market price".":..... :There's something we can consider in the future as well. We could also have Coop on the side that can pay us as members for the work we do and that coop gets hired out by the nonprofit. But this doesn't have to be done immediately, it could just help with getting people paid."

2.1: Marketing

MEETING OF 2025 12 12 , 5pm EST

Need: someone who is very good at high sales / high payoff marketing that gets the job done 👍✅ critical
— Sarah is a professional in this, gone to school and has had career experience. Let's try to engage her. I'm sure she'd love to talk to you and give you pointers of how to structure the investigation of what would work. we also need target audience(s) assigned. demographics of who we're trying to reach.

Ario: to me things like organization structure, the gross aspect of marketing, and investing are things that are smart to delegate to those who can get results without much trial and error.

1 bad marketing campaign can make people auto-disinterested in whatever else you have to say in the attention economy.

Ario: i have a team that works out of philippines with very good rates for marketing/SEO and even web design.

—> delegation is more so an act of proper use of intelligence imo to focus our efforts on aspects of the operation that require conscious oversight - considering we are not omnipresent.

but considering you're lead person on IT, let's talk about it! cause there are people that are very advanced not just in IT but aspects of marketing that are proven to work

Justin: But I believe we are looking for a form of team work in it. That's the work. I'll be posting what I have done so far. And I would love parts of it to be done by others in time. I admit it's taken me a long time. But it is the basis for dozens of sites not just one

Example Branding aesthetic: Samantha Pleet <https://samanthapleet.com>

Dana (mid February 2025) Dear marketing team, this is the website I mentioned in the meeting. It used to have a darkly colored background and high contrast but still, *note the custom font and differently themed pages.*

Price setting advice for products / sales :

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?si=n77p5squ8zsdpr2K&v=IWpBxHqU1G8&feature=youtu.be>

Ideas from 02/26:

*-Book themed website with creative interface (long term project via Justin)**

Ideas from 03/26:

1. **Branding Aesthetics:**

https://www.instagram.com/p/DVOuD_VfLe/?igsh=czMazlycWtyaGJw

I also enjoy this **vintage print poster style way of presenting information**. It's what the 70s **psychedelic style is based on sort of but it's more 1910s style** (Dana)

2. **Content style of presentation for Social Media:**

<https://www.instagram.com/reel/DVKfHgQjrBY/?igsh=OXJ6YtI6YXZpZjhq>

an idea for how we can attract customers / members... Look at this organization which is making cool little **posts about ideas and artists , philosophies and beliefs, etc**

Then they say "join us" at the end ...So this is a way of sharing knowledge and learning etc etc and we could do it about any subject. We don't have to show our faces to do it

Another idea: <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DUwYoiVkb9U/?igsh=dWpiNjFsZjB0ZWsy>

concept of **introducing a book through "story time" where we just read key quotes.**

(13/02/2026) Marketing Team Meeting Feb 13 2026 Sarah, Dana, Justin...was Jason there ?

Task: Brainstorm Mission, Vision — Come up with coherent mission and vision statements

What is our purpose? Who is the intended audience? What is the benefit to them?

Purpose: education, learning --learning what?--, Knowledge try not to use 4th way religion cosmology or occult Conscious presence cultivate attention but not too ideological, not grounded in ideology at first

Mission statement: function not form, form can be in esthetics

Website: says a lot about form not function. - **important info should be obvious in first 10 seconds of looking at website, all on landing page, then more information spiderwebs out for people interested**

Audience: is artists, creatives

One really cool idea of benefit is as a not for profit we create artists grant...

Also, bookstore (online or physical, could sell art and other things too...)? Reading groups?

(We have meetings, guided sittings, meditation as well)

QUESTIONS:

What is benefit to people of signing on?

Will government give us status ... OK to talk about religion but how are we useful?

What do we do? Needs to be more obvious, we don't need to censor ourselves

Brand Esthetic Wishes / Notes:

Philosophical Research Society model ... if you were on there marketing team what would you do for them? -they reach out to diverse communities and give speakers platform.

-websites-» Workshop Websites Very Direct Immediate, not black and white colors... unique Font

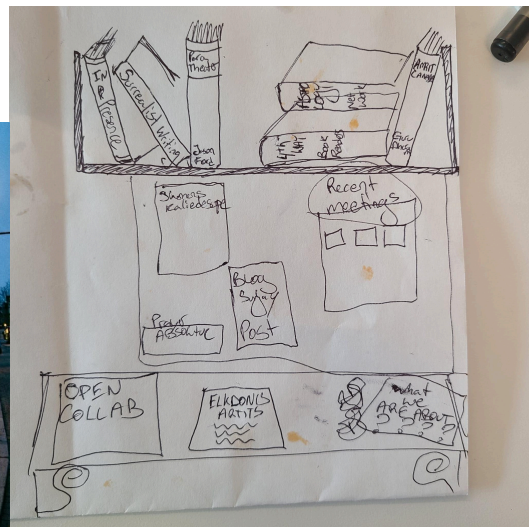
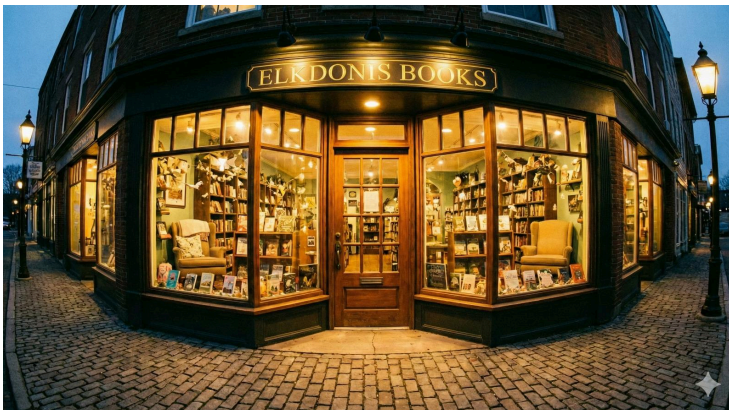
LandingPage Website -»minimal scrolling , all options provided at once (I imagine a News site)

Our focus product right now is Workshops...

(Justin) My ask:

- ☐ please provide me with visual sketches of layouts colors, navigation
- ☐ For your website, if you each had say your own workshop or website-offering.

Justin's Creative "Book" Website Plan





Justin (02/26) Above is my concept of a unified Website design across multiple sites tied together as though the sites are books, on a book shelf. Above a corkboard which is the featured content recent post or meetings to go to. It begins by 'entering' through the first storefront entry page.

[3:49 p.m., 2026-02-13] Justin : **I was considering a web design like a book... that's open.** And there's just two pages the left and right. That can be gone between. The right is the workshop space. The left is the details page.. the workshop space is simply an embedded video conference people can automatically join with a countdown timer to the start of the next session...The focus moves like a camera from left to right when swiped or scrolled

Sarah - Marketing Progress Plan (02/26):

One thing: in my notes I put some thoughts I had afterwards in parenthesis. **I am going to hopefully draft an agenda for each meeting sometime each Thursday. For the next meeting we will continue to discuss where we left off yesterday. If you have suggestions for the agenda and can send them to me**

Jason (02/26): here's a summary of what I was bringing to discuss:

Landing pages

Build landing pages and sales pages with guru D. Dana and Sarah. Get more conversions per visit for our offers.

Sales funnels

Maximise revenue from every visitor with carefully crafted sales funnels. Create and manage with Dana, Sarah and GuruD.

Checkouts & Order Bumps

Take payments on our own website with beautiful, highly customized checkout page design, including order bumps.

Upsells & Downsells

Increase average order values with intelligent upsells and downsell sales flows, and track conversions with funnels.

Theme Builder

Get free SEO traffic to our offers with high impact blogs - this builds a sustainable flywheel in our business.

Online Courses

Grow recurring revenue with online courses and membership sites. Fully customized to match our brand and website.

Jason (01/26) Other thoughts:

we include a protocol for working with failure into the business models.

I also am starting to think that we could be an arts and entrepreneurship collective. And this is a real value unmet need in our society.

I want to be able to take any course or workshop idea, drop it into the business and it sells itself.

This can also be an unmet need valuable to clients.

We have started starting a business. Once we consolidate all the efforts we have made I wish to move to the next phase which is making the business automatic.(Scalable)

After that phase we can dominate our markets, develop a legacy and then sell the business.

Aim high, think like minimum seven figures annually. So picture an entrepreneur that only needs an

idea to input into our business framework to create a gig for themselves.

As a hub for innovation and entrepreneurship we will also attract clients for the courses etc.

(03/03/26) Marketing meeting notes

There should be an overarching brand image. (we already brainstormed a lot....)

We will have sub sections for different products / events. — This is easy to just do as separate pages on the wordpress for now.

The documentary could be the first step for creating an aesthetic — if we win the grant... It could be a good project anyways (on a small scale). — Then we will have something to put on youtube and social media...

2.3: Outreach and Marketing Plan — Documentary Idea

Our outreach and marketing plan is designed to ensure that the documentary has a broad, lasting impact and that anarchist ideas are disseminated to diverse audiences. We will use a multi-pronged strategy to share the completed documentary and engage communities in meaningful ways. Key components of our outreach plan include the following:

1. **Online Distribution and Streaming:**
We will release the documentary on major online platforms such as YouTube, Vimeo, and social media channels, making it freely accessible to the public. This will allow for wide dissemination of anarchist ideas, reaching audiences across North America, Europe, and globally. We will also leverage the collective's existing networks—including artist communities, anarchist organizations, and cultural spaces—by promoting the release through newsletters, online forums, and partner platforms.
2. **Local and International Screenings:**
We plan to organize a series of in-person and virtual screenings in cities where our collective is based—Toronto, Los Angeles, and Paris—as well as in other locations where we have connections. Screenings will be held in alternative community spaces, independent bookstores, cultural hubs, and activist centers. These screenings will include facilitated discussions, Q&A sessions with members of the collective, and interactive workshops, deepening audience engagement with the documentary's themes.
3. **Collaborations with Anarchist Networks and Media Outlets:**
We will partner with established anarchist media platforms, such as podcasts, zines, websites, and community radio programs, to promote the documentary and host in-depth conversations about its content. These outlets will help reach dedicated anarchist and radical communities, ensuring that the ideas explored in the documentary resonate with engaged and active audiences. We will also collaborate with the sponsor of our Canadian tour to integrate live performances and workshops tied to the film's themes.
4. **Interactive Workshops and Educational Outreach:**
A key part of our outreach plan involves hosting follow-up workshops and educational sessions. These will be offered both in

person and online, allowing participants to explore anarchist principles, Earth-based art practices, and auto-didactic learning approaches. We will connect with youth groups, independent artists, and community organizers, offering these workshops as a way to extend the documentary's impact beyond viewing, fostering hands-on engagement and learning.

5. **Social Media and Digital Marketing Campaign:**

We will run a targeted social media campaign around the release of the documentary, using visual teasers, behind-the-scenes footage, and member interviews to build interest. We will use platforms such as Instagram, Twitter, and Facebook to share content that highlights the process of creating the documentary, the balance assemblage performances, and the collective's anarchist vision. Hashtags, collaborations with influencers in the anarchist and arts communities, and engagement with followers will help amplify the documentary's reach.

6. **Nomadic Reading Room and Future Projects:**

The documentary will serve as a catalyst for the Elkdons Arts Collective's future initiatives, including the launch of a nomadic anarchist reading room and open-concept bookstore, online workshops for artists and writers, and paratheater performance laboratories. By promoting these upcoming projects alongside the film's release, we will create a sustained engagement with audiences, encouraging them to participate in future collective endeavors rooted in anarchist and rhizomatic principles.

7. **Accessibility and Translation:**

Although translation was not budgeted in the current phase, the collective is committed to making the documentary accessible to a broader audience in future iterations. We plan to create subtitles in multiple languages, starting with French, to ensure that viewers across language barriers can engage with the film's content. Closed captions will also be provided for accessibility.

Intended Impact on Audience and Community:

We envision the documentary having a strong impact on multiple levels. First, it will introduce anarchist ideas—particularly around non-hierarchical collaboration, auto-didactic learning, and Earth-based art—to both general and niche audiences. Through immersive performances like balance assemblages and paratheater, viewers will experience anarchist principles in action, breaking down preconceived notions of what art, community, and resistance can look like.

Second, the documentary will foster cross-cultural connections, linking audiences in Canada, the U.S., and Europe through a shared exploration of history, land, and radical imagination. By grounding the project in real-world spaces and collective experiences, we hope to inspire viewers to rethink their relationships to art, community, and their own agency in creating alternative futures. Finally, beyond the film itself, the accompanying workshops, screenings, and collaborations will create lasting spaces for dialogue, reflection, and creative intervention. We aim to equip viewers with tools and inspiration to apply anarchist values in their own communities, extending the documentary's influence far beyond the screen.

3. The Grant application / Anarchist Research Grants:

Read this page for details on the two different grants they offer and what they can be used for:

https://anarchiststudies.org/grants-faq/?utm_source=ig&utm_medium=social&utm_content=link_in_bio&fbclid=PAb21jcAQCe3tleHRuA2FlbQlXMQBzcnRjBmFwcF9pZA81NjcwNjcNNDMzNTI0MjcAAac2NvRmjeFWU27jzdo_6_NtODH0M5JVtYSn13WGLcyg_OgJyJG0KQdcMKQrw_aem_mBoOutCfdblvXvJdxusDA

What each grant is specifically looking for:

<https://anarchiststudies.org/grants-for-radical-writers-and-translators/>

This is the online form for application to either of 2 grants they offer (I think):

https://cryptpad.fr/form/?fbclid=PAT01DUAQCd6RleHRuA2FlbQlXMAbZcnRjBmFwcF9pZA81NjcwNjcNNDMzNTI0MjcAAadi9rV3qmpDyMP5QnyJ_QzB4zIV4jOJ5LPckWLT2w6skhBoFbP77f8Nt6-UDg_aem5ml_RP2tV3teSRhl7nCElQ#/2/form/view/qANtKJom-y-HlMIMQx-to2O2tSKsstB11lCQ0VNB9Ls/

Here is what I ended up doing in case you want to use these materials, including info about the opportunity and how they conceived of Anarchy — *About the Grants:*

For nearly thirty years, the IAS has funded creative intellectual work that furthers anarchist ideas and makes them accessible to a broad audience. Since 2023, we've collaborated with [Agency](#) to offer two grant programs: the Anarchist Horizons Grant and the Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant.

The Anarchist Horizons grant program supports a variety of radical projects, including written works, translations, artwork, performance, workshops, and events. The Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant program, named [in honor of the late anarchist media activist Jen Angel](#), supports multimedia projects that help translate anarchist ideas and practices for the general public.

We typically award several micro-grants (\$300-\$1500), prioritizing smaller proposals so that we can fund multiple projects each year. *Priority is given to creators who are BIPOC, queer and trans/nonbinary, low-income, currently or formerly incarcerated, and/or working outside of academia. Submissions from applicants outside of the United States are welcome.*

In general, our grant programs aim to support work that is focused on the following projects:

- Preserving movement memory and recent history
- Reflecting on forgotten or buried histories
- Developing anarchist theory, including on economics
- Making previously inaccessible anarchist materials available in translation
- Building anarchist infrastructure and radical alternatives
- Uplifting on-the-ground projects and models of success
- Addressing key anarchist concepts for popular audiences
- Reaching children and younger people
- Imagining transformative futures

Note that if proposing an event or workshop, the proceedings should be filmed, recorded, or otherwise made sharable. *Topics for This Year's Applications*

1. For the 2026-2025 Anarchist Horizons Grant, we are specifically looking for works that take an intersectional anarchist approach and that highlight the following topics:
 - Reflections on anarchism (in all its forms, with and without the label) as well as resistance to fascism, genocide, and ecocide
 - Radical visions for a better future and the theories and actions to help us get there
 - Reportbacks from on-the-ground efforts on successes, challenges, and needs
 - Stories, narratives, and histories, connecting our past, present, and future movements
 - Anti-fascism, immigration, and migrant justice

Tip: Preparing all the required information and materials in advance: You will need to: succinctly summarize your project, audience, and outreach plan; provide links to your previous video work; and also provide a budget, and timeline for completion.

1. The Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant was founded in 2023 in memory of Jen Angel, long-time anarchist and independent media activist. Organized by Agency and the Institute for Anarchist Studies, this grant specifically supports multimedia projects that seek to make anarchist ideas accessible to the general public.

Application Guidelines and Preparation

For our applications, we use an online submission form. We recommend preparing all required materials in advance of beginning the online application. You will need to succinctly summarize your project, audience, and outreach plan, as well as provide a budget and timeline for completion. Please pay careful attention to character limits. For further guidance, we recommend reading the [Grants FAQ](#)

and our guide on [“How to Apply for a Grant”](#) (also available in a [more accessible format](#)) before beginning your application.

Applicants will be asked to specify which grant program they wish to be considered for, either the Anarchist Horizons Grant or the Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant. Applications can only be submitted for one grant program per application form, though applicants may submit multiple forms.

Tip: Total Amount Available, Budget, Use of Projects:

- \$6,250.00 is available separately for each grant program. We would like to award several grants in the \$300-\$1,500 range, prioritizing smaller proposals so that we can fund multiple projects. Amounts should specifically reflect costs in the project.
- A budget is requested as part of the application. Successful applications will include the following: total amount required for completion, a detailed breakdown of needs and amounts (personal expenses like childcare and food are welcome), support expected or already funded from other sources, and any in-kind donations you anticipate or have already secured. Please include only one item per line for readability.
- Material funded by the Anarchist Horizons Grant and Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant will be available for the IAS and Agency to host, share, and excerpt at will, while being credited to the creators, who are also free to use and share it at will.

Tips: Frequently Asked Questions to Keep in Mind:

Q: Can people outside of the U.S. apply for a grant?

A: Yes, we welcome applications from all over the world.

Q: Can I apply for a grant as an academic?

A: Yes, but we prioritize grants outside of academia, since academics already have more access to funding.

Q: How much money should I ask for?

A: Ask for what you need for your project according to your budget, but be aware that smaller amounts (\$500-\$1500) may be prioritized in order to fund more projects.

Q: If I receive a grant, what will be expected of me?

A: You will be expected to officially accept the grant and provide information when you receive your acceptance letter, so please make sure to check the email account that you applied with, and be ready to receive payment.

If you decide to accept the grant, you will be connected with an IAS or Agency board member (depending on which grant you applied for) as your point person on the project moving forward. In this role, they will coordinate information between you, and IAS or Agency, facilitate the development of an appropriate timeline, provide any necessary support for the ongoing project, and eventually help disseminate your work when it is complete.

2026 Application: IAS Anarchist Horizons Grant / Agency Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant

Project Information and Budget: This section will require you to summarize your proposed project and explain in detail exactly how the grant funds would be used. It's a good idea to have your budget details prepared in advance before completing this section.

14. Please describe your proposed project. Be as clear and specific as you can. What will you create, write, or produce? (2000 characters maximum)

We propose creating a documentary (about 1 hour long maximum) introducing the “Elkdonis Arts Collective”, an international anarchist art collective with key members based in Toronto, Los Angeles, and Paris. The documentary will capture our groundbreaking multidisciplinary practice, which merges performance, visual art, creative writing, music, and philosophy. It will serve as both a powerful stand-alone artistic statement and a key tool to share our vision with a broad, global audience.

The core of the documentary will showcase our signature “balance assemblage” (rock balancing) sculptural performances—astonishing, gravity-defying formations of stone, rubble, and found materials that invite viewers into transcendental experiences. These performances will take place across Canada, in urban and natural settings, revealing the delicate interplay between human creativity, the land, and shared space. Filmed scenes of these ephemeral sculptures will be interwoven with footage

of our other artistic practices: paratheater performances, energy healing rituals, immersive readings, and creative writing workshops that embody our collective's anarchist and reductionist principles.

We will introduce the audience to the collective's foundational philosophy of essentialism, timelessness, and the primacy of space—art reflecting “vertical time” and shared participation. Viewers will hear the stories of our members: auto-didactic creatives, occultists, musicians, performance artists, writers, and historians who embody rhizomatic, non-hierarchical learning. Co-founder Dana, based in Paris, brings deep expertise as a historical tour guide, storyteller, and informal / autodidactic (hands on) researcher focused on folklore, sociology, art history, colonialism, and land-based knowledge. Other key members based in North America contribute expertise in performance, ritual, music, and community engagement.

The documentary will emphasize our commitment to radical inquiry and anarchist education. It will highlight how we work outside centralized hierarchies in collaborative, flexible, and evolving manner. We want to ask questions of what it means to be human, to resist capitalist and colonial structures, and envision new futures.

Key focus of the documentary: future projects the Collective is building toward: a nomadic anarchist “reading room” (an open-concept bookstore that will travel between community spaces), online workshops for freelance writers and artists, entrepreneurial development programs for independent creatives, interactive public events centered on key anarchist and experimental texts, and “para theater” performance art laboratories. The doc will lay the groundwork for these future initiatives and engage a wider audience.

This documentary will preserve movement memory and reflect on radical concepts of learning, human knowledge & lore. It will translate anarchist ideas into accessible, experiential formats for both local and global audiences. It will challenge viewers to rethink their relationship to space, time, and the creative act, while demonstrating how anarchist values of mutual aid, decentralization, and radical imagination can manifest.

Our goal is to create a living, evolving artifact that will inspire participation in the collective's future projects, foster community engagement, and share an expansive vision.

FINAL WHICH WAS SUBMITTED - DOCUMENTARY PROPOSAL:

We propose creating a documentary (1 hour long max) introducing “Elkdonis Arts Collective”, an international anarchist art collective with key members based in Toronto, Los Angeles, and Paris. The documentary will capture our groundbreaking multidisciplinary practice, which merges performance, visual art, creative writing, music, and philosophy. It will serve as both a powerful stand-alone artistic statement and a key tool to share our vision with a broad, global audience.

The core of the documentary will showcase our signature “balance assemblage” (rock balancing) sculptural performances—astonishing, gravity-defying formations of stone, rubble, and found materials that invite viewers into transcendental experiences. These performances will take place across Canada, in urban and natural settings, revealing the delicate interplay between human creativity, the land, and shared space. Filmed scenes of these sculptures will be interwoven with footage of our other artistic practices: paratheater performances, energy healing rituals, immersive readings, and creative writing workshops that embody our collective's anarchist and reductionist principles.

We will introduce the audience to the collective's foundational philosophy of essentialism, timelessness, and the primacy of space—art reflecting eternity and shared participation. Viewers will hear the stories of our members: auto-didactic creatives, occultists, musicians, performance artists, writers, and historians who embody rhizomatic, non-hierarchical learning. Co-founder Dana, based in Paris, brings deep expertise as a historical tour guide, storyteller, and informal / autodidactic (hands on) researcher focused on folklore, sociology, art history, colonialism, and land-based knowledge. Other key members based in North America contribute expertise in performance, ritual, music, and community engagement. This documentary will preserve movement memory, reflect on radical concepts of learning human knowledge & lore.

Character limit: 0/2000

15. What is the name or title of your proposed project?

Earth, Art, and Anarchy: Between Worlds with the Elkdonis Collective

16. Please describe how your proposed project meets the criteria of the specific grant you selected above (either the Anarchist Horizons or Jen Angel Media Grant)?

It will emphasize our commitment to radical inquiry and anarchist education. It will highlight how we work outside centralized hierarchies in collaborative, flexible, and evolving ways. We ask questions of what it means to be human, to resist capitalist and colonial structures, and envision new futures.

Key focus of the documentary is future projects we are building toward: a nomadic anarchist "reading room" (an open-concept bookstore that will travel amongst community spaces), online workshops for writers and artists, entrepreneurial development programs for creatives, interactive public events & performance art "laboratories". It will translate anarchist ideas into accessible, experiential formats for both local and global audiences. It will challenge viewers to rethink their relationship to space, time, and the creative act, while demonstrating how anarchist values of mutual aid, decentralization & radical imagination can manifest. It will lay the groundwork & engage our audiences.

Required

Character limit: 0/1000

17. What is the total amount of funding the project requires for completion? (Note: this is not necessarily the same as the amount you are requesting for the grant.)

Total predicted amount of funding required for completion: \$5,000~.

We've streamlined the total project budget to \$5,000 by leveraging remote collaboration. Our international team—based in Toronto, Los Angeles, and Paris—will film performances, interviews, and creative segments locally, eliminating major travel and lodging expenses. The full budget covers essential costs: equipment rentals, honorariums for performers, editing services, sound design, and outreach. By working where we are and contributing significant in-kind labor for planning, directing, and post-production, we've kept the budget lean while maintaining the project's ambitious vision. We've already secured partial funding for some portions of the project, including contributions toward post-production and community outreach efforts. We are requesting a micro-grant of \$1,500 to supplement these secured funds and in-kind support. This grant will play a key role in funding the initial phase: the filming of our balance assemblage performances and key interviews with collective members. This will allow us to produce a vital 15-30 minute pilot segment of the documentary, which we'll use to engage the community, secure additional funding, and propel the project forward into the next phase of full production. Our phased approach, combined with secured partial funding and in-kind contributions, reflects our commitment and seriousness. This \$1,500 micro-grant is the crucial piece that will catalyze the project's next steps and ensure the successful completion of the full documentary.

Required

18. List all expenses related to the project, one per line for readability, please. Include all rates and total amounts, e.g. " Condenser microphone rental: \$40/day for 6 days: \$240." The IAS recognizes that writers and mediamakers also need to subsist and thrive. Expenses may include things like food costs, childcare, or other personal expenses. The total amount listed must equal the amount quoted above in question 3 as the total amount required for completion.

Project Expenses

1. Camera rental: \$75/day for 10 days: \$750
2. Audio equipment (microphone, recorder) rental: \$40/day for 10 days: \$400
3. Lighting equipment rental: \$30/day for 10 days: \$300
4. Editing services (post-production, 2 weeks at \$400/week): \$800
5. Sound mixing and design: \$300 flat fee
6. Performer/interview subject honorariums (6 key participants at \$100 each): \$600
7. Graphic design (titles, credits, motion graphics): \$250
8. Food costs for on-location shoots (5 shoot days x \$20/day): \$100

9. Living expenses for artists/producers (subsistence, rent, utilities): \$1,100
10. Transportation costs for filming (local travel between locations, across Canada, Paris, LA): \$400
11. Internet/data costs for remote collaboration: \$150
12. Contingency (5% buffer): \$150

Total: \$5,000

Character limit: 0/1000

19. What other sources of support for this project have you sought or secured, including in-kind donations? Please list them one per line, for readability. Please also indicate whether the support is projected or confirmed, e.g. "7 hrs. childcare at \$15/hr: \$105 (confirmed)."

Required

1. Financial aid - confirmed sponsor/collaborator, Canadian tour with Jason (performance art specialist): \$3,000 (confirmed)
2. Confirmed In-kind contributions:
 - Jason Ford: 40 hours of performance art, directing, and facilitation services, valued at \$50/hour: \$2,000
 - Dana, Jason, Justin: 30 hours of writing workshops, paratheater performance facilitation, valued at \$45/hour: \$1,350
 - Sarah(Toronto-based): 20 hours of filming and production assistance, valued at \$40/hour: \$800
 - Ario (Los Angeles-based): 20 hours of musical composition, sound design, and editing assistance, valued at \$40/hour: \$800
 - Dana (Paris-based): 15 hours of research, storytelling for documentary script development, valued at \$40/hour: \$600
 - Additional time from others: 25 hours of general support (coordination, logistics, digital collaboration), valued at \$35/hour: \$875
3. Personal contributions from members to cover remaining budget difference: Projected (flexible, as needed)

Character limit: 0/1000

Grant request amount: How much money would you require from the IAS in order for this project to be fully completed? Note: the grant request amount (question 6) plus the other sources of support (both projected and confirmed) from question 5 must equal the total amount the project requires (given in question 3). The IAS seeks to fund as many quality projects as possible. Though large dollar amounts are sometimes granted, we will prioritize projects which request less than the total amount of grant monies available (i.e projects less than \$6,250).

We are requesting \$1,500 from the IAS to fully complete our proposed documentary project. The total project budget is \$5,000, and we have already secured \$3,000 in confirmed financial support from a sponsor and collaborator for a Canadian tour with our co-founder, Jason. The remaining \$2,000 represents the additional cash needed to complete the project.

We are asking IAS for \$1,500 of this amount. This request falls comfortably within the IAS's prioritized micro-grant range and will fund essential components of the project, including initial filming of key performances, interviews, and production elements. The remaining \$500 will be covered through personal contributions from collective members and future small fundraising efforts, demonstrating our strong internal commitment and financial responsibility.

In addition to financial aid, we have secured significant in-kind contributions from members of the collective, including skilled services such as performance art, script and writing facilitation/services, production assistance, musical composition, research, and coordination. These in-kind contributions ensure that all creative and labor aspects of the project are accounted for, further strengthening the project's feasibility.

The IAS grant will provide the vital supplemental support needed to complete this documentary, and will allow us to create a powerful, finished work that introduces the Elkdoris Arts Collective to the public and helps us launch future anarchist art initiatives.

Outreach and Marketing Plan

Part of the mission of the IAS is to support the development of anarchist ideas and interventions and disseminate them as widely as possible. In this section, we want to hear about how you will share your project and how you see it having an impact on your intended audience, readership, or community.

Our outreach and marketing plan is designed to ensure that the documentary has a broad, lasting impact and that anarchist ideas are disseminated to diverse audiences. We will use a multi-pronged strategy to share the completed documentary and engage communities in meaningful ways. Key components of our outreach plan include the following:

1. **Online Distribution and Streaming:**
We will release the documentary on major online platforms such as YouTube, Vimeo, and social media channels, making it freely accessible to the public. This will allow for wide dissemination of anarchist ideas, reaching audiences across North America, Europe, and globally. We will also leverage the collective's existing networks—including artist communities, anarchist organizations, and cultural spaces—by promoting the release through newsletters, online forums, and partner platforms.
2. **Local and International Screenings:**
We plan to organize a series of in-person and virtual screenings in cities where our collective is based—Toronto, Los Angeles, and Paris—as well as in other locations where we have connections. Screenings will be held in alternative community spaces, independent bookstores, cultural hubs, and activist centers. These screenings will include facilitated discussions, Q&A sessions with members of the collective, and interactive workshops, deepening audience engagement with the documentary's themes.
3. **Collaborations with Anarchist Networks and Media Outlets:**
We will partner with established anarchist media platforms, such as podcasts, zines, websites, and community radio programs, to promote the documentary and host in-depth conversations about its content. These outlets will help reach dedicated anarchist and radical communities, ensuring that the ideas explored in the documentary resonate with engaged and active audiences. We will also collaborate with the sponsor of our Canadian tour to integrate live performances and workshops tied to the film's themes.
4. **Interactive Workshops and Educational Outreach:**
A key part of our outreach plan involves hosting follow-up workshops and educational sessions. These will be offered both in person and online, allowing participants to explore anarchist principles, Earth-based art practices, and auto-didactic learning approaches. We will connect with youth groups, independent artists, and community organizers, offering these workshops as a way to extend the documentary's impact beyond viewing, fostering hands-on engagement and learning.
5. **Social Media and Digital Marketing Campaign:**
We will run a targeted social media campaign around the release of the documentary, using visual teasers, behind-the-scenes footage, and member interviews to build interest. We will use platforms such as Instagram, Twitter, and Facebook to share content that highlights the process of creating the documentary, the balance assemblage performances, and the collective's anarchist vision. Hashtags, collaborations with influencers in the anarchist and arts communities, and engagement with followers will help amplify the documentary's reach.
6. **Nomadic Reading Room and Future Projects:**
The documentary will serve as a catalyst for the Elkdons Arts Collective's future initiatives, including the launch of a nomadic anarchist reading room and open-concept bookstore, online workshops for artists and writers, and paratheater performance laboratories. By promoting these upcoming projects alongside the film's release, we will create a sustained engagement with audiences, encouraging them to participate in future collective endeavors rooted in anarchist and rhizomatic principles.
7. **Accessibility and Translation:**
Although translation was not budgeted in the current phase, the collective is committed to making the documentary accessible to a broader audience in future iterations. We plan to create subtitles in multiple languages, starting with French, to ensure that viewers across language barriers can engage with the film's content. Closed captions will also be provided for accessibility.

Intended Impact on Audience and Community:

We envision the documentary having a strong impact on multiple levels. First, it will introduce anarchist ideas—particularly around non-hierarchical collaboration, auto-didactic learning, and Earth-based art—to both general and niche audiences. Through immersive performances like balance assemblages and paratheater, viewers will experience anarchist principles in action, breaking down preconceived notions of what art, community, and resistance can look like.

Second, the documentary will foster cross-cultural connections, linking audiences in Canada, the U.S., and Europe through a shared exploration of history, land, and radical imagination. By grounding the project in real-world spaces and collective experiences, we hope to inspire viewers to rethink their relationships to art, community, and their own agency in creating alternative futures.

Finally, beyond the film itself, the accompanying workshops, screenings, and collaborations will create lasting spaces for dialogue, reflection, and creative intervention. We aim to equip viewers with tools and inspiration to apply anarchist values in their own communities, extending the documentary's influence far beyond the screen.

21. Who is your intended audience or readership? What impact do you hope this project will have for that audience? (1000 characters maximum)

Our intended audience is outsider artists, radical creatives, writers, performers, and independent thinkers—those working on the fringes of mainstream art and society. This includes anarchists, auto-didacts, experimental artists, and those seeking non-hierarchical, collective-based ways of creating and living. We aim to reach people who resonate with anarchist ideas, whether or not they use that label: people who resist conventional structures, embrace experimentation, and want to imagine new futures.

We hope this project will inspire these individuals to see the power of collective art as a form of resistance, connection, and inquiry. By showcasing the Elkdons Arts Collective's vision, we want to ignite a sense of belonging and possibility, encouraging viewers to pursue their own radical, independent projects—or even join our collective. Ultimately, we aim to inspire creative autonomy, mutual aid, and bold, transformative action.

What is your outreach plan? How will you share this work with your intended audience? Please explain. Please include any social media campaigns, readings, exhibitions, performances, broadcasts, or any other ways this work might enter the world. (1000 characters maximum)

We will share the doc through multiple channels. First, we'll release it on major online platforms (YouTube, Vimeo) making it accessible globally. We'll run a social media campaign on Instagram & Facebook using teasers, behind-the-scenes footage, and member interviews to engage our audience. Second, we'll organize in-person and virtual screenings in Toronto, Los Angeles, and Paris, partnering with local art spaces & radical bookstores. These screenings will include Q&A sessions, workshops, and live performances by members.

Third, we'll collaborate with anarchist media outlets—podcasts, zines, and websites—to feature the documentary and spark conversations. Co-founders can draw power and attention from pre-existing personal and professional networks. Finally, we'll promote future projects like our nomadic reading room and online workshops alongside the film, building ongoing engagement. We have knowledge of SEO marketing + with a collective member who has prof background in marketing

Please provide a brief outline of your timeline for completion. The project must be completed within 12 months of receiving the funds, but applicants are encouraged to complete their work sooner, if possible. (1000 characters maximum)

Month 1-2:

Pre-production: finalize script outline, coordinate remote filming schedules, secure equipment rentals, and confirm interview subjects.

Month 3-5:

Production: local filming in Toronto, Los Angeles, and Paris. Capture balance assemblage performances, interviews, and supporting footage. Begin initial editing of pilot segment.

Month 6-7:

Post-production: full editing, sound design, and graphic work. Finalize the 40-45 minute documentary cut. Add captions for accessibility.

Month 8-9:

Outreach preparations: develop social media assets, coordinate with anarchist media channels, and schedule in-person and virtual screenings. Build partnerships with local art spaces and community groups.

Month 10-12:

Release and distribution: launch the documentary online, host screenings and workshops, promote through social media, and engage with audiences. Gather feedback and prepare for future projects.

(Summary of Grant I applied to for us on 2/03/26' - Dana)

The Anarchist Horizons grant program supports a variety of radical projects, including written works, translations, artwork, performance, workshops, and events. The Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant program, named [in honor of the late anarchist media activist Jen Angel](#), supports multimedia projects that help translate anarchist ideas and practices for the general public

We typically award several micro-grants (\$300-\$1500), **prioritizing smaller proposals** so that we can fund multiple projects each year. Priority is given to creators who are BIPOC, **queer** and trans/nonbinary, **low-income**, incarcerated, and **working outside of academia**. (I argue we are an outsider / experimental art group of intellectuals who promote open source learning - and founding members have a history of experience with disability / human rights activism and therefore we also are and support low income communities. We identify as queer — (if) we should emphasize this to be selected.?

Applicants will be asked to choose the specific grant they wish to apply for, either the Anarchist Horizons Grant or the Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant. **Applications can only be submitted for one type of grant per application form.**

1. The 2025 Anarchist Horizons Grant (Cool, but I couldn't figure out a way to propose all of our ideas together).

The Anarchist Horizons grant program is awarded by the IAS and supports a variety of radical projects, including: written works, translations, artwork, performance, workshops, and events. In particular, we are looking for work that takes an intersectional anarchist approach and that highlights::

- **Reflections on anarchism (in all its forms, with and without the label)** as well as resistance to fascism, genocide, and ecocide
- **Radical visions for a better future and the theories and actions to help us get there**
- **Reportbacks from on-the-ground efforts on successes, challenges, and needs**
- **Stories, narratives, and histories, connecting our past, present, and future movements**
- Anti-fascism, immigration, and migrant justice

2. **The 2025 Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant (I think this one better suits our existing ideas that we are ready to launch - A DOCUMENTARY).**

The Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant was founded in 2023 in memory of Jen Angel, long-time anarchist and independent media activist. Organized by Agency and the Institute for Anarchist Studies, this grant specifically supports multimedia projects that seek to make anarchist ideas accessible to the general public. Examples of media projects designed in this spirit, include:

- [It Did Happen Here Podcast](#)
- ["We're All We've Got, We're All We Need"](#) | Mutual Aid Disaster Relief
- ["What is the State?"](#) | AK Press/Agency

More information about the Jen Angel Anarchist Media Grant can be found on the [Agency website](#).

Product / Courses / Workshops we are Prepared to Offer:

We need at least 2-3 workshop concepts with a rough curriculum

Dana: plan this starting ASAP so by spring it can be "launched".

I am talking to this artist who publishes art books as products btw and he is giving me insider tips from the international gallery world. Not that it is useful directly for workshops but I have "contacts" growing that could someday assist.

Dana: I want to bounce a promotional idea (for spring and summer 2026) off the group and start a related grant application ASAP —

- Spring / summer could be a social media and marketing launch.
- Workshops can happen online for money as soon as the marketing is existing and there are clients to make that happen. Clients can also be organic clients.
- ***Do you have enough clients to start any of the online workshops you've planned yet?***

1. Exquisite corpse creative writing - promotional materials already made. (Dana)
2. Music Workshop (ario)
3. Enneagram workshop (ario)

2. Elkdoris Labs which have their own curriculum . (Jason)

3. Reading group (s) about whatever material (Everyone?)

About BTTHG: Justin: As a reading group and looked into different reading sites groups esl efforts, performance forums etc for potential posting compaigns

Networking Next Steps:

1. Social media pages should exist (BOTH a facebook and Instagram page, linked)
2. <https://www.ifacgroup.com/>

basically as soon as Elkdons Arts is ready we can make a formal request to team up with them (EJs people)...

QUESTION??? why haven't we approached them about the Buddha painting as an asset & sale? 👍 What would that involve?

I think one of us at bare minimum has to start regularly attending EJs morning meetings to connect with him and just make it known I'm present. It might have to be me since it's me on the IFAC page.

Anyone have any ideas on how to include EJ Gold, or his people, him himself being an expert in the art world

Dana: Well technically I'm part of IFAC with EJ Gold himself.... In case you forgot... I could at any time re announce my readiness and start meeting with them

3. *BTTHG Reading Group (based in Australia, online community Dana was invited)*

Gurdjieff readings start up again I believe — Beelzebub reading

Dates : 3 févr. 2026 à 08:30-09:45, UTC+1 Lieu :

https://parallax-media-network.mn.co/events/beelzebubs-ales-to-his-grandson-by-g-i-gurdjieff-90776861?instance_index=20251007T063000Z 8:30 am CEST every Tuesday

4. International education conference and that we can sign up to host / broadcast a workshop or presentation: <https://www.learning-planet.org/fr/calendar/>

I don't know what, how or who would do this and I don't know if it's always happening, but here's the sign up form — this is one way of getting attention once we are ready with PRODUCTS!

I made us an account. If you log in there's a form to PROPOSE AN EVENT:

Email log in: danamccoolart@gmail.com

Password: fourthwayearthway

More information on what it is and how it works:

<https://www.learning-planet.org/fr/who-are-we/>

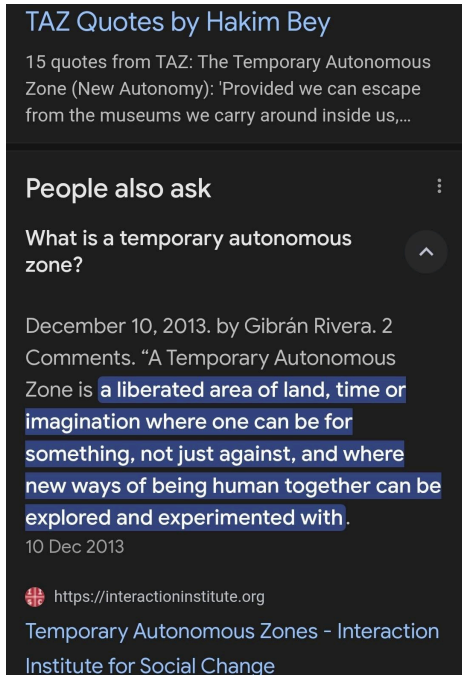
Key Words Brainstorm — These are helpful for AI prompts:

*****AESTHETICS / STYLE:** Essential, timeless, necessity visually striking, materiality , transcendental, Symbolism, symbols, medieval, occult, nature, vedas, deities, buddha, gods, ancient, new age, vibrant, classic, 70s, 60s, psychedelic, radical, contrast, zen, hypnotic, collage, eclectic, open minded, alternative, subculture, rituals, folk, outsider art, 90s eclecticism, esalen style, fusion, implosion, exciting, unique, mystical, magical, mysterious, positive, serious, mature, intelligent, crazy, playful, out there, decorative, contemporary, avant garde, organic, cutting edge, intriguing

HOW —- FORM / ACTIONS / VERBS (?): Accessible, Interactive, Reflexive, Open minded, anarchist, research, performance, theatre, dance, painting, writing, collage, radio, lectures, teaching, seminars, games, learning, networking, events , event organizing, salon, meeting place, security, open source, ritual, invocation, reading, esalen style, human potential movement, learning, being, doing, expansion, listening, healing, community,

WHAT —- CONTENT & SUBJECT MATTER / THEMES: (in any of the content, now or later): human potential movement , humanistic psychology, creativity and creative development, art (all kinds: collage, dramaturge, material products and immaterial all considered), entrepreneurial development, raves, comedy, community aid, culture, freedom, wisdom, knowledge, seeking, therapeutic modalities, healing, psychology, languages, finding, enlightenment, meditation, mindfulness, occult, esoteric, astrology, psychics, metaphysics, channelling, seance, mediumship, hypnotism, automatism,

energy work, health and well being, alternative well being movements (TCM, Yoga, All of it), physics



and sciences, environmentalism, the environment, nature, nature spirits, geography, history, travel, civilization, sociology, evolution, space, earth, the universe, god, inner / outer, relationships, (Self improvement and self discovery — somatic, emotional, mental, psychic etc), karma, sustainability (?) philosophy, religion, theology, theosophy (all these classic books you find in 20th century occultism), technology, AI, video games, the future, coding, robots, etc. Music, concerts, narrative, story telling, poetry, literature, experiential based, interactive, installation art

TEMPORARY AUTONOMOUS ZONE: Temporary Autonomous Zones | The Anarchist Library

<https://share.google/RzxkBhAInlCOPmwUu>

WHY — FUNCTION / PURPOSE: (Accessible) workshops, education, seminar and community event space, library, book store, gallery, theatre stage, studio (all art forms, or a specific range or selection?)... also Cafe?

--- Entrepreneurial development hub, Digital and in person networking, International Database / Network, Application / App, Promotion for Artists, Event Organizing

suggesting a million projects right off the bat is a bit overwhelming when we are working on basically holding an energetic space 🌌 and getting our shit together first 🏆 (ideally) 😊

WHO — TARGET AUDIENCE: Creatives (all), Entrepreneurs — all ages or 18+?

100% I will say, whether or not we attract "loyal" followers or a public that's willing to support us is a direct reflection of our own energetic presence and how consistently we show up with the intention for this to be a real and prosperous organization.

important question: How is Elkdonis Arts NOT a cult / a sect? (In France this is perceived as a very

negative thing).

--- one point of discussion: what changes things is how or if money is involved and how it's used.

--- my advice: keep fourth way related items out of the mission statement in the beginning and allocate them to a section of the website (not hidden but not highlighted) for now. Basically the inner circle has to be separate

like in literally every single fourth way school or with every single real fourth way teacher I've ever seen or read.... It's COMPLETELY POSSIBLE TO TALK ABOUT, TEACH, REFLECT ON AND WRITE ABOUT THE FOURTH WAY.... WITHOUT.... ever actually identifying it as a movement or specific sect or anything that sounds religious. This is kind of true to the original philosophy of it always changing forms and appearing and re appearing anyways

Focus on content NOT ideology. People find the later suspicious and unattractive in many cultures / contexts ---- ultimately the fourth way will be only a part of what this collective can do, it can include other complimentary or just different activities and ideas even from the beginning

WHERE — International Online Presence - Major Cities: Paris - LA - Toronto --- Aim for a Storefront in what location(s)?

ROLE MODEL ORGS & THEIR RESPECTIVE WEBSITES:

1. Paullaffoley.net

deeply interdisciplinary / has to do with a fusion of all his interests which is quite difficult to pull off

---- He made several paintings about the fourth way and Ouspenskys ideas

2. Universal Healing <https://www.universal-healing.org/>

Long distance energy healing --- example of international community based around esoteric ideas and how to present them to the public , how to promote online international events

1. NEW THINKING ALLOWED - <https://newthinkingallowed.org/>

-unique online video archive and open source parapsychology learning community.

- challenges definition of library: great example of “anarchist research” methodology - Inspiring

eclecticism and subcultural knowledge documentation... hosted by famous personality Jeffery Mishlove who was the first person to get a PhD in parapsychology Archive of talk show interviews that are iconic. This comes in handy when we need inspiration for lectures or guest artists, seminars, workshops.....

- truly impressive range of topics that seamlessly falls into their mission statement to “allow new thinking” etc

2. Philosophical Research Society (LA): <https://www.prs.org/>

*****Ario lives near by and can easily visit them and their in person events

- Event calendar & social media is inspirational

3. Seekers' Books (TO)

-we have the direct contact of Patrick the owner

-***Justin, Jason, Stephan can easily speak to him in person

4. Alternity (TO)

I i don't like them socially but I admit we have the contact of the owner , and the concept is similar & successful.

5. American library of Paris (Paris)

-I'm a member and could volunteer to learn more about library responsibilities. This is a successful historically important not for profit organisation

6. Abbey Book Shop (Paris):

- Tried to get a full time book store manager internship but blocked for now (2025) due to money / time. It exists, could try in 26' once a grant covers living expenses.
-

4. San Francisco Books (Paris)

- I have never been here but want to see it , and maybe ask about employment / internship

5. Guy Trédaine éditeur Books

-seems to be an alternative medicine French book store .. has some big names in there

- completely French, never been inside.

6. BOOK STORES & LIBRARIES IN LONDON, ENGLAND

- several on a list I will visit on Jan 13th in London

7. FAMOUS OLD OCCULT LIBRARY IN AMSTERDAM*

-its on the research list

[8:23 p.m., 2026-02-01] Dana: I want Elkdonis arts to be aware of

8: International education conference and that we can sign up to host / broadcast a workshop or presentation: <https://www.learning-planet.org/fr/calendar/>

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WHEN — 2026 let's aim for big funding — What's the concrete timeline? What are our stages of development and milestones?

UPCOMING TRAINING / LEARNING EVENTS USEFUL TO US:

<https://workmanarts.com/education/> (there's a book publishing course I can take which will discuss the business of books / publishing and literature)

— Registration opens Dec 16th.

5. ARTIST STATEMENT & PITCH MATERIAL

PREVIOUS ARTIST STATEMENT MATERIALS:

We are Elkdons Arts collective, a performance and visual arts group. We work to restore the necessity of art in life for all.

Elkdons comes from the ancient Greek word “Helkdons”, which means objective “prayer for God” (not prayer for self)

We propose a series of Earth, Community, and History honouring sculptural performances along the river Seine, a Unesco world heritage site. These performances accentuate awareness of the shared spaces we meet in and the value of labyrinth and surprise in the environment.

A viewer will find a troupe of guides playing an astonishing game; impossible assemblages of rock and rubble just barely balancing. Viewers watch the installation of a circle or a line of balance assemblages. Some are invited to learn and create their own assemblages.

We have been widely recognized for our invention of the balance assemblage sculptural performance and game, and our work also has involved actively and prominently exploring innovative artistic expressions with Salons, Tours and Performances, Raves and Rituals.

Though difficult to classify in one neat category, our art reveals a tendency towards guiding viewers into transcendent sensations and subtlety, that reveal our classical artistic backgrounds and our intuitive, visionary qualities. We are the collective creators of a monumental oeuvre that displays expertise of draftsmanship, diversity and proficiency in almost every artistic medium, including video and music recording. All of our work speaks of fertility of imagination, technical expertise and uncompromising discipline.

Jason Ford and Dana McCool are a duo of artists who officially founded the Elkdons Arts Collective. Together they authored an artistic movement at the cutting edge of experimentation that minimizes habitual elaboration in order for the viewer’s experiential expectations, previously experienced visual

and emotional stimuli, and stored perceptual patterns, to determine perception of self in the moment.

Although our collective in practice is broadly inclusive, experimental and evolving, its art is nonetheless often characterized by three basic qualities:

Essentialism - Our art uses recognizable objects and is therefore representational. However, objects are important for their effect, not important in themselves. The artist attempts to achieve an effect with

the fewest possible lines and details, removing extraneous elements which may deviate or obscure the

effect...thus this approach is called Reductionism. Objects are reduced to their essentials in a move toward the abstract. Similarly, colour is used unambiguously and powerfully to enhance its effect.

Colours are few, vibrant, sharply contrasting.

Timelessness - Reductionism typically explores another dimension of time, a dimension which is not sequential or "horizontal" but eternal or "vertical"...the same dimension of time which contains the creative act itself. There is little or no explicit movement in Reductionist art. Nothing is happening in the usual sense and therefore, time does not pass. The result is an enhanced awareness of posture, positioning of visual elements and their inter-relationships. Freezing the frame, rendering objects static, also has the effect of freeing other forms of movement such as feeling...motion through emotion.

Space - Perhaps the outstanding feature of our approach to art is that, despite a limited use of the techniques of perspective to create three dimensional effects within the picture or space surrounding sculpture, the art nonetheless establishes a sense of space. The reason is the primary place assigned to

the viewer. Because the Reductionist artist strives for communication, scenes are composed for a viewer who is not a voyeur outside the scene but rather a participant who is the reason for the work and necessarily a part of it. Everything in the scene is oriented first and foremost to the viewer so as to bring the viewer into a relationship with it. Depth of field is therefore not bounded by the frame but includes the viewer in a truly three dimensional experience of space. Thus, the art is only completed by viewing.

Our works are timeless essential, reductionist and often violate scale, at once denying dimension and perspective, by making use of color, form, texture, negative space, forced perspective, compressions, color field and figure-ground relationships. We typically explore the vertical dimension of time which contains the creative act itself and by orienting everything toward the viewer, brings one into a relationship with it.

Our stone balancing performances are among the collective's most haunting and penetrating offerings. They reach the viewer on deeper levels of being and cultivate a transcendental view. They are intimate portraits of our beings in the moment, in vertical relationship with the space . Viewers become respectful of the magnificence and exaltation, often creating a sensation of peace because of the exquisite impossibility demonstrated and the awakened desire to know beauty directly fulfilled.

As artists we tend to be visionary, provocative and shamanic; we skirt the borders of reality and its subtle interfaces. We create spaces for artwork with an unmistakable transcendent quality. Our performances seem to expand our consciousness, and attune our senses. The sculptures created range through a broad spectrum and can be both brilliant and subtle while remaining reflective of the shared space because they are literally pieces of the buildings roads and the land. Participants attain a controlled group harmonic electrical vibration that resonates in harmony with higher emotions. Often jarring and shocking, the sculptural artifacts disarm and take one's breath away. In short, the viewer is offered a gateway to the top floor of artistic inquiry. Therein lies their key.

What is Art For?

The artist endeavours to penetrate experience in order to know the self and the world. It is a difficult and never ending process to find ways of using a medium to interpret something seen and experienced

into a form which can be received and seen by another. To persevere in this process despite frustration and failure requires commitment and work, driven in large part by human necessity.

The Collective is presently committed to three major programs:

- Creating art as the medium to inquire into our shared human existence.

- Providing a sanctuary where beauty and inquiry can meet.
- Providing Education & Community by providing demonstrations, workshops, _____ and inviting access to our process as it happens.

Extra remark: *(Justin) Emphasize we are creating a web 3.0 infrastructure. We mean to support artists by employing it.*

Final remarks:

The collective is committed to using art as the means of inquiry.

Each inquiry focuses on a particular question that is grounded in what it is to be human.

Resonant works and spaces are included in the inquiry.

New works are often created in public spaces in response to the proposed inquiry.

Placement and the relationships between pieces creates an experience for the viewer to participate in.

This is how this show evolves.

A willingness to be part of such a collaboration is essential to the participants but work must also be compatible with the exploration that is in process.

We understand that working inquiry while exposed to the public is not a way all artists wish to work.

We are unique in our purpose and are not commercial.

Our works are intended to be experienced, not sold.

Seeing the collected documentation of the works undertaken in public is a further process of discovery for anyone who may wish to hold space for this.

(Justin) Emphasize we are creating a web 3.0 infrastructure. We mean to support artists by employing it.

(JASON) --- HERE'S A SIMPLIFIED VERSION OF FIRST ARTIST STATEMENT WITH MORE PRACTICAL NOTES

Elkdonis Arts Collective: Where Art Meets Transcendence

We're Elkdonis Arts Collective, a dynamic performance and visual arts group dedicated to reinstating the significance of art in everyday life. Our artistic journey is deeply rooted in exploring the intersections of Earth, Community, and History through captivating sculptural performances. Imagine strolling along the Seine River, a UNESCO World Heritage site, and stumbling upon a troupe of artists engaged in an intriguing game of balance and creativity. Our balance assemblage performances feature impossible structures of rock and rubble, delicately balanced to defy gravity and inspire awe.

Artistic Philosophy

Our artistic approach is built around three core principles:

- **Essentialism:** We use recognizable objects to convey emotions and ideas, stripping away unnecessary elements to reveal the essence of the art piece. This reductionist approach allows us to create powerful, abstract works that resonate with viewers.
- **Timelessness:** Our art exists outside the confines of time, inviting viewers to experience the eternal present. By freezing moments in time, we unlock new dimensions of perception and emotional connection.
- **Space:** We prioritize the viewer's experience, crafting scenes that envelop and engage. Our art establishes a sense of space that transcends physical boundaries, drawing the viewer into a

profound relationship with the work.

Stone Balancing Performances

Our stone balancing performances are a testament to the human spirit's capacity for creativity and transcendence. These ephemeral works of art challenge the boundaries of physics and perception, leaving viewers in a state of wonder and contemplation. By creating intimate portraits of our beings in the moment, we invite viewers to connect with the art on a deeper level.

Community Engagement

We're committed to sharing our artistic vision with the community through:

- Workshops: Hands-on experiences where participants can learn and create their own assemblages.
- Demonstrations: Live performances that showcase our artistic process and inspire creativity.
- Videos: Documenting our process and performances to share with a wider audience.

Join the Journey

If you're curious about our work or would like to learn more, please visit our website. We invite you to experience the transformative power of art and join us on this journey of discovery and creativity .

ON SUFISM:

Our new member, @+1 (619) 559-8053 asked me about the Sufi focus.

We pass on the message of my Sufi benefactor who suggested that real Sufis don't need to be named anything. He said we are "those who do not".

This refinement made by Sharif implies that the work has outgrown its labels and that it's our obligation to see what that means for us who are in a position to pass on the message of the lineage.

Our lineage was founded by Hazrat Inayat Kahn and carried on by his son and his grandson. Here's a bit of context and a summary of the refinements made.

Sufism is a mystical tradition within Islam that focuses on the inner dimension of faith and the pursuit of spiritual growth. It's a rich and diverse path that emphasizes:

1. **Love and devotion:** Sufis cultivate a deep love for the Divine and strive to embody qualities like compassion, kindness, and forgiveness.
2. **Spiritual purification:** Sufis aim to purify their hearts and minds through practices like meditation, self-reflection, and self-discipline.
3. **Inner journey:** Sufism is a journey of self-discovery, where individuals seek to understand their true nature and their relationship with the Divine.
4. **Unity and interconnectedness:** Sufis believe in the unity of all existence and strive to see the Divine in all things.
5. **Spiritual guidance:** Sufis often seek guidance from spiritual teachers or guides, known as Sufi shaykhs or pirs, who have undergone extensive spiritual training.

Sufism is not a separate sect within Islam, but rather a spiritual approach to understanding and experiencing the faith. It's a path that emphasizes the inner dimensions of spirituality and encourages individuals to cultivate a deep sense of inner peace, love, and connection with the Divine .

Sufis and dervishes are terms often used interchangeably, but they have distinct connotations within the Sufi tradition.

Sufis:

- Sufis are individuals who follow the Sufi path, a mystical tradition within Islam that emphasizes spiritual growth, self-purification, and a deep connection with the Divine.
- Sufis engage in various spiritual practices, such as meditation, prayer, and self-reflection, to cultivate a deeper understanding of themselves and their relationship with the Divine.
- Sufism is a broad term that encompasses a wide range of spiritual practices, philosophies, and

traditions.

Dervishes:

- Dervishes are a specific group of Sufis who are known for their intense spiritual practices, often involving physical movements, music, and devotional rituals.
- Dervishes are typically associated with specific Sufi orders or tariqas, such as the Mevlevi Order, which is famous for its whirling dervishes.
- The term "dervish" is often used to describe a Sufi who has dedicated their life to spiritual pursuits and has undergone extensive training and discipline.

In essence, all dervishes are Sufis, but not all Sufis are dervishes. While Sufism is a broader term that encompasses a wide range of spiritual practices and traditions, the term "dervish" specifically refers to a group of Sufis who engage in intense spiritual practices and devotional rituals.

Hazrat Inayat Khan's Universal Sufism is a unique blend of spiritual traditions, drawing primarily from Islamic Sufism, particularly the Chishti order. However, his teachings also incorporate elements from various other spiritual traditions, making it a universal and inclusive approach to spirituality.

While rooted in Islamic Sufism, Khan's Universal Sufism emphasizes the unity of all religions and focuses on the inner dimensions of spirituality, making it accessible to people from diverse backgrounds. His teachings draw parallels with other spiritual traditions, including Christianity, Buddhism, and others, but do not affiliate with any particular one.

Some key aspects of Khan's Universal Sufism include :

- Emphasis on love and harmony: Reflecting the Chishti order's focus on love and devotion
- Unity of all religions: Believing that all spiritual traditions share a common goal and essence
- Inclusivity: Open to people from all backgrounds and faiths
- Spiritual practices: Including meditation, music, and self-reflection, tailored to individual needs

Khan's approach has been influential in popularizing Sufism in the West, and his teachings continue to inspire people worldwide, transcending denominational boundaries.

Pir Vilayat Inayat Khan refined his father Hazrat Inayat Khan's teachings by :

- **Emphasizing Direct Experience:** Pir Vilayat focused on the personal experience of spirituality, encouraging individuals to seek direct knowledge of the divine rather than just intellectual understanding.
- **Integrating Spirituality into Daily Life:** He stressed the importance of translating spirituality into everyday life, making it practical and applicable to modern challenges.
- **Universal and Inclusive Approach:** Building on his father's message of unity and love, Pir Vilayat's teachings emphasized the interconnectedness of all existence and the potential for spiritual growth through various paths.
- **Cosmic Perspective:** He encouraged his students to extend their self-image into the cosmic vastness, recognizing that we are not separate entities but part of a larger whole.
- **Meditation and Inner Reflection:** Pir Vilayat taught various meditation practices and encouraged inner reflection to help individuals discover their true nature and connection to the divine.
- **Reconciling Opposites:** He emphasized the Sufi path of reconciling irreconcilables, finding balance between different aspects of life and spirituality.

By refining his father's teachings, Pir Vilayat Inayat Khan made Sufism more accessible to a broader audience, while maintaining the core principles of love, compassion, and spiritual growth.

Pir Zia Inayat Khan's Refinements

- **Emphasis on Integration:** Pir Zia focuses on integrating the various aspects of the self, including body, mind, heart, and soul, to achieve wholeness and balance in life.
- **Relevance of Sufism in Modern Times:** He highlights the importance of applying Sufi principles in contemporary life, making spirituality practical and accessible.
- **Universal and Inclusive Approach:** Pir Zia's teachings emphasize unity, love, and compassion, encouraging individuals to look beyond differences and cultivate a sense of oneness with all humanity.
- **Importance of Self-Awareness and Mindfulness:** He stresses the need for self-reflection, mindfulness, and introspection to deepen one's spiritual practice and understanding.
- **Cultivating Compassion and Empathy:** Pir Zia's teachings encourage individuals to develop a heart-centered approach to life, fostering compassion, empathy, and kindness towards all beings.
- **Sustainable Living and Environmental Stewardship:** He emphasizes the importance of living in

harmony with nature and recognizing the interconnectedness of all living beings .

The Inayati Order's Focus

- **Spiritual Growth and Self-Realization:** The Inayati Order emphasizes the importance of individual spiritual growth and self-realization through various practices, including meditation and self-reflection.
- **Interfaith Dialogue and Understanding:** The order promotes interfaith dialogue and understanding, recognizing the value of diverse spiritual traditions and the importance of unity and cooperation.
- **Community Building and Service:** The Inayati Order encourages community building and service to others, fostering a sense of connection and responsibility among its members.
- **Preserving and Sharing Sufi Heritage:** The order preserves and shares the Sufi heritage of Hazrat Inayat Khan, making his teachings and legacy accessible to a wider audience .

[6:00 p.m., 2026-02-13] Jason Ford Private: Our group focus is on a universally inclusive spiritually, and Art as a vehicle.

We embody and pass on the message of the Spirit of Guidance.

[6:06 p.m., 2026-02-13] Jason Ford Private: We are a fourth way school in the Chisti tradition. We publically front as an arts collective with nothing to prove.

Allah means thee Nothing.....

We have seven traditional activities we work to inquire into and maintain:

"Universal Worship, [Kinship], and the Inner School ... help one to perfection." — Hazrat Inayat Khan

Over the course of his life, Hazrat Inayat Khan envisioned and developed Seven Activities to help one explore the inner life and how this life relates to the outer world.

The Inner School

The Inner School is the primary vehicle of Sufi training and education for initiates. This training is

provided through various online gatherings. Meditation, Prayer, zhkr and ritual are a few of the ways we inquire.

Universal Worship

Universal Worship is the inter-religious activity of our group, promoting harmony between the world's major religious traditions, primarily through a Universal Worship service. In this service, ordained facilitators light candles symbolically representing the world's religious traditions and read from their sacred texts, often introducing participants to an experience of the teachings, music, or chants of these traditions. For more information, you can send adm to me.

Kinship

Kinship cultivates the natural connection of one heart to another, fostering harmony, goodwill, and caring action. Kinship inspires people to work together to serve those in need, to protect and restore the web of life on Earth, and to create a more just and beautiful world. Our work together awakens the conscience and builds the spiritual maturity needed to address the needs of the day.

Collective members can hold a kinship meeting at will.

Music

Music cultivates and explores the mystical aspects inherent to music and sound, through individual and collective study, concerts, and gathering musicians to sing and play music together.

The Healing Activity

The Healing Activity offers education and training in the teachings and techniques of spiritual healing taught by Hazrat Inayat Khan, and others, emphasizing attunement, prayer, breath, and concentration.

Knighthood of Purity

Knighthood of Purity promotes the service-oriented, chivalric values of Hazrat Inayat Khan. Those seeking to study and practice the Iron, Copper, Silver and Golden Rules, the philosophy and art of life, whether Sufi initiates or not, are eligible to join.

Ziraat

Ziraat is an activity which uses the symbols and processes of agriculture to promote an understanding

of the earth's sacredness, and to describe and facilitate growth in the inner life, bridging both the material and spiritual worlds.

We also have several public facing activities brewing. Stay attuned.

Gestures of Awakening

In the stillness of the moment, we find the seeds of transformation. Like a delicate flower unfolding its petals, our gestures can become offerings to the unknown, invitations to the divine to enter our lives. As artists and seekers, we are called to craft these gestures with intention and awareness, allowing them to become conduits for the timeless truth that lies beyond the reach of ordinary consciousness.

The whispers of the ancient ones echo through the ages, reminding us that the secrets of the universe are hidden in plain sight, waiting to be uncovered through our direct experience. Like a master craftsman shaping raw material into a work of art, we can shape our lives into a masterpiece of awareness, each gesture a brushstroke on the canvas of existence.

As we embark on this journey, we may find that the familiar contours of our reality begin to shift, like the sands of a desert landscape sculpted by the winds of change. The ordinary becomes extraordinary, and the mundane is infused with the sacred. In this alchemical process, we are transformed, our essence revealed like a hidden treasure uncovered in the depths of our own being.

And so, we make gestures that are not just movements of the body, but invitations to the soul. We create art that is not just a reflection of reality, but a refraction of the light that shines through us. In this way, we become co-creators with the universe, our gestures becoming a language that speaks directly to the heart.

(03/03/26)

Art as vehicle is a concept where creative expression becomes a means to access deeper states of consciousness and inner transformation. It's about using art to tap into your inner world, transcending external validation and expectations.

Think of it like this: instead of creating art for an audience, you're creating art for yourself, as a way to explore your own depths. This approach can involve various practices, such as:

- Using ritualistic actions or movements to access altered states
- Focusing on the process, not the outcome
- Tapping into ancient traditions or energies
- Exploring the body's wisdom and physicality

The goal is to use art as a vehicle to:

- Access deeper levels of awareness
- Transcend ego-driven creativity
- Connect with something greater than yourself
- Facilitate personal growth and transformation

It's a powerful way to shift your relationship with art, making it a tool for inner exploration and self-discovery .

How does that resonate with you?

(03/03/26)

1. mission statement
2. first project scope of work
3. gofundme

[12:50 a.m., 2026-03-04] Ario New Number: - separation of NON PROFIT from specific interests of group (i.e. fourth way, buddhism, art performance, paratheater)

The specific interests are CONTRACTED projects by elkdonis

[1:08 a.m., 2026-03-04] Ario New Number: The purposes of the corporation are to establish and operate a secular community organization dedicated to arts, education, and cultural exchange for public benefit. The corporation shall provide accessible educational programs, workshops, lectures, and learning opportunities across diverse disciplines, including the arts, philosophy, science, and cultural studies. It shall support artists, educators, thinkers, and creatives by offering opportunities to present, develop, and share artistic and intellectual work. The corporation shall engage and support youth and emerging creatives through education, mentorship, and community-based learning, and

may collaborate with individuals and organizations locally, nationally, and internationally in furtherance of these purposes.

Most important things that need to be in the new website landing page:

Curation of Ideas, Topics

Education, Learning

Supporting Creative Development & People

WHAT, WHY, HOW

Elkdonis Arts Collective: Where Art Meets Transcendence

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OR

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The Collective is presently committed to three major programs:

- Creating art as the medium to inquire into our shared human existence.
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- **Space:** We prioritize the viewer's experience, crafting scenes that envelop and engage. Our art establishes a sense of space that transcends physical boundaries, drawing the viewer into a profound relationship with the work.

(longer version:)

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Essentialism - Our art uses recognizable objects and is therefore representational. However, objects are important for their effect, not important in themselves. The artist attempts to achieve an effect with the fewest possible lines and details, removing extraneous elements which may deviate or obscure the effect...thus this approach is called Reductionism. Objects are reduced to their essentials in a move toward the abstract. Similarly, colour is used unambiguously and powerfully to enhance its effect.

Colours are few, vibrant, sharply contrasting.

Timelessness - Reductionism typically explores another dimension of time, a dimension which is not sequential or "horizontal" but eternal or "vertical"...the same dimension of time which contains the creative act itself. There is little or no explicit movement in Reductionist art. Nothing is happening in the usual sense and therefore, time does not pass. The result is an enhanced awareness of posture, positioning of visual elements and their inter-relationships. Freezing the frame, rendering objects static, also has the effect of freeing other forms of movement such as feeling...motion through emotion.

Space - Perhaps the outstanding feature of our approach to art is that, despite a limited use of the techniques of perspective to create three dimensional effects within the picture or space surrounding sculpture, the art nonetheless establishes a sense of space. The reason is the primary place assigned to the viewer. Because the Reductionist artist strives for communication, scenes are composed for a viewer who is not a voyeur outside the scene but rather a participant who is the reason for the work and necessarily a part of it. Everything in the scene is oriented first and foremost to the viewer so as to bring the viewer into a relationship with it. Depth of field is therefore not bounded by the frame but includes the viewer in a truly three dimensional experience of space. Thus, the art is only completed by viewing.

Our works are timeless essential, reductionist and often violate scale, at once denying dimension and perspective, by making use of color, form, texture, negative space, forced perspective, compressions, color field and figure-ground relationships. We typically explore the vertical dimension of time which contains the creative act itself and by orienting everything toward the viewer, brings one into a relationship with it.

